The Book of Awesome

By Neil Pasricha

INTRODUCTION

Polar ice caps are melting, hurricanes swirl in the sea, Wars are heating up around the world, and the job market is in the Deep Freeze. Whoa, it's getting pretty ugly out there. That's why it never hurts to take a step back and enjoy the little things in life that make it less dreary and more awesome.

Based on the award-winning 10-million-plus-hit blog 1000awesomethings.com, The Book of Awesome by Neil Pasricha is an international bestselling high-five for humanity and a big celebration of life's little moments.

NEIL: One. Wearing underwear just out of the wash.

Now tell me is there anything quotes so nice as wrapping yourself in a pair of steaming undies just out of the dryer? It's like skinny dipping in a hot tub, jumping on a horse that's been in the sun all day, and lying on a warm, sandy beach… combined! Sure the moment doesn't last long, yes, there may be some static cling, and it's true, you'll have to get changed really quickly in the laundry room to pull it off, but dang girl. Hot undies. They is fine. AWESOME!

Two. Tripping and realizing that no one saw you.

Learning to walk ain't easy. Sure, you did it and I did it but we probably couldn't do it again. Like learning anything tough and life altering, learning to walk is a messy process that takes time and practice. Unfortunately, the bad news is that practice doesn't always make perfect. Even though we've been mastering the art of standing tall for years, and years, and years, everyone slips and falls now and then. So next time your shoe catches on the top step, you trip stepping off the airport's moving sidewalk, or you bail on a patch of ice outside your front door, remember that not too long ago you couldn't walk at all. So your wipe out is really no big deal. As long as no one saw you. AWESOME!

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Three. Remembering a word that has been on the tip of your tongue all day.

It's like throwing a pail of cold water on all of your smoking inner head parts. Gears unjam, lines start rolling, and you settle back in your seat with a satisfied smile on your face and just blurt out, "Parcheesi that's what it was called!" AWESOME!

Four. Hearing a stranger fart in public.

What's funnier than hearing a stranger fart in public? Well sure, it can happen in a bank line up, hotel lobby, restaurant, or subway car. It can happen in a restaurant, movie theater, or local library. But the funniest of all has got to be the Elevator farts. That's the king of public farts. Little kids are always the funniest. I once heard a child in an elevator say, "Mommy, that man just farted," with a full on finger point right into the well-dressed butt in front of his face. But hey, I guess if you're going to fart in a kid's face, you deserve to be called out. Yes, hearing a stranger fart in public can be a tiny, hilarious moment in the middle of any day. If you are the farter I say be loud and be proud we have all been there so no need to be embarrassed. If you are in the audience, I say Enjoy the hilarious social faux pas and resulting reaction in the room. So thank you, stranger farting in public, for adding a little comic relief to the middle of our day. AWESOME!

Five. Getting a truck driver to blow the horn.

Truckers have the best horns. Those things mean business. They're a loud and thundering slap in your face. See when a minivan lets out an itty-bitty beep-beep telling you the light turned green, it sounds like a seagull telling other seagulls "Hey, there is a guy tossing crust over here." When a trucker does the same thing it's a full on roar the sound a tugboat would make if it was about to crash into a lighthouse. Sometimes, when you are driving down the highway, the hours keep going and going and going. For kids without distractions, it can seem like days back there, strapped in and sitting in a numbing silence broken up only by potholes and passing motorcycles. That's why getting a trucker to blow his horn is so great. It's a laugh and a fun, little interactive break from highway monotony. Plus, it's a time passer. It's a secret moment on wheels, a honkin' highway holler and some good old-fashioned bonding in the fast lane. So let's give thanks to

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truckers for not taking life too seriously for indulging our simple pleasures and for rocking that blasting air horn in a special moment I like to call AWESOME!

Six. The Five Second Rule.

The five second rule simply states that any food dropped on the floor is perfectly okay to pick up as long as you do it within five seconds. The Five Second Rule has many variations, including The Three Second Rule, The Seven Second Rule, and the extremely handy, However Long it Takes Me to Pick it up off the Floor Rule. But whatever version you use, there is just no denying ***why*** it is so great.

1. It makes you look less disgusting. Because now when you eat that wet grape that rolled into the corner by the heating vent and collected some cat hair and a few dry toast crumbs, you're not disgusting. No, you're just a law-abiding citizen. Big difference.

2. Saves time and money. Wait, wait, wait, don't pull the peanut butter and jelly out again and make a whole new sandwich. No, we'll just blow the floor spices off this one, and maybe tear off the wet, soggy piece of crust that landed in the juice puddle. It's all good.

3. It's scientifically proven. Well, actually it's scientifically proven that if a floor is covered in salmonella or E. coli, your food will be covered in salmonella or E. coli, even if they touch for only a split second. But, here's the kicker, that same University of Illinois study showed no significant evidence of contamination on public flooring in general. Good save science! So people, I give you a friend and savior in these tough times: the five second rule. Know it. Love it. Live by it. AWESOME!

Seven. Eating a sample you have no intention of buying.

Why hello, little cup of strawberry-kiwi punch.

How are you doing, pepper-dill crackers?

Don't mind if I do, tiny salami wrapped around a piece of melon.

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Yes, eating a free sample of something you have no intention of buying is a great way to stay on top of what's happening in the grocery store. You swish the new drink, chew the new gum, toss back a tiny cup of the new pasta dinner, and introduce your taste buds to a little surprise. Assuming you don't actually like the product, maybe you do what I do and pretend you're going to buy it anyway, so you don't hurt the sweet, heavily lipsticked Sample Lady's feelings. So you pick up the box of dry crackers, salty salami of all-noodle no cheese lasagna and say, "Hmmm. $4.29? Not bad, not bad. And I get a fifty-cent coupon too? Hmmm." Then you smile back a her, toss it in your cart, and say "Why not! Thank you very much!" Then you roll out of sight and guiltily drop it in another aisle. AWESOME!

Eight. Absolute perfect silence.

Nine. Squeezing through a door without touching it.

Tiny squirts of adrenaline pump into your bloodstream when you pull of this classic movie. Yes, suddenly you morph from Guy Walking Down the Street into Indiana Jones in that Scene Where He Slides Under the Wall at the Last Second. Your hands stay clean, your strut stays mean, and you zip through that closing door and don't look back, hoping it doesn't nail anybody in the face behind you. AWESOME!

Ten. Remembering someone's name.

I have a problem. Within seconds of meeting somebody I completely forget their name. Sure, I introduce myself. Shake hands, and jump right into the conversation, but I can't fully concentrate because I realize their name has immediately disappeared from my memory. Cursing myself I silently scan my frontal lobe, but my pink and lumpy mush is bright white and empty. So I smile and nod along, but inside I'm frustrated. But it's even worse when they use my name right away.

"So Neil, where you from, Neil." They'll ask innocently, but I'm too busy combing through cobweb-covered spare parts in skull factory to properly answer them. My eye

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contact drifts and I get distracted and fidgety. It's at these desperate times I try one of the two name-teasing techniques.

1. **The take two.** A friend joins my side at the party and I say to the mystery man, "Oh, have you met Chad?" hoping that Chad will put out his hand and lean in with a "Nice to meet you! Sorry, what was your name?" If Chad nails it, I give him a hi-five later. If he doesn't, I throw a cup of punch in his face and tell him to get it right next time.

2. **The spell check.** If I don't remember their name, but I think it was long and complicated, then I ask them to spell it for me. If they say P-a-r-d-e-e-p then I'm all aces, if they say P-a-m, then I'm an idiot. High risk high reward. Sure there techniques look easy, but the truth is that they're awkward and embarrassing to use with no guaranteed results. Let's be honest. It's much more satisfying to actually remember and drop their name right at the beginning of a sentence with confidence, like you've been old friends for years. Then they'll look back at you with beaming eyes and a bright smile that shows you two are getting to know each other. Yay, maybe you'll become friends, maybe you'll do business, maybe you'll start dating. All because you remembered their name at the party. Nice move you! AWESOME!

And finally, remembering how lucky we are to be here.

So let's stop for a second and pull back again let's pull way, way, way back. Life is so great that we only get a tiny moment to enjoy everything we see. And that moment is right now. And that moment is counting down. And that moment is always, always fleeting. You will never be as young as you are right now. Let's all high five and keep thinking wild thoughts, dreaming big dreams, and laughing loud laughs.

AWESOME!

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SOURCE INFORMATION

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AWARD HISTORY

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